

WEDNESDAY

JESUS WELCOMES PEOPLE FROM EVERY CULTURE

MEMORY VERSE

Love your enemies. Pray for those who hurt you. If you do this, then you will be true sons of your Father in heaven. Matthew 5:44-45 ICB

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INTRODUCTION LOVING PEOPLE FROM DIFFERENT CULTURES

One of the greatest evidences of God's love working on our hearts, and changing us to become more like Him, is our ability to be kind and respectful to people from all cultures, and with all kinds of diversity. We can love them as brothers and sisters, whatever they believe and whatever they do. We can help our children to respect and love others by being careful to talk kindly about people of other nationalities, and those who have different lifestyles, traditions, and religions.

The story of the Good Samaritan reminds us that sometimes the most unlikely people will come to our aid, because the love of God has transformed them too, even if they seem to be different from us. It also reminds us that however different we are, in whatever way, we are all citizens of planet earth, beloved children of God, and potential neighbors in the earth made new.

So, use today's lesson and activities to help your children grow more like Jesus by being kind, respectful and inclusive in their interactions with everyone they meet.

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Read together
the story of the
good Samaritan
that Jesus told:
Luke 10

Jesus wants everyone in the world to know that they are God's beloved children. During His ministry on earth, He didn't have time to travel far. He couldn't make a movie or podcast or preach a sermon online. But He could show God's love by welcoming, loving and helping people from other cultures.

Jesus was sad when anyone was rude to people from other countries, or when they thought they were better than the people who were different to them. Jesus was sad that many Jews hated people from other countries. They hated the Romans who ruled their country. They hated the Egyptians who made them slaves. They hated the Babylonians who invaded and destroyed their country. And they especially hated the Samaritans, who lived close by and even worshipped the same God!

Jesus wanted to challenge their unkind beliefs. He was kind to the Samaritan woman He met by the well, and He healed a Samaritan leper, who came back to thank Him. He wanted to show us how to treat everyone with kindness and respect. So, He told a special story about the kindness of a foreigner to change the way that people thought about those who were different to them (Luke 10:25-37).

Sam was a businessman from Samaria. He travelled with his donkey on long and dangerous journeys. He always packed extra food, water, and bandages, just in case there was an accident or an emergency.

One day, as he travelled down the desert road, he saw a priest walking

very quickly towards him. As soon as he saw Sam, the Samaritan, he shuddered, looked away, and crossed to the other side of the road. Sam sighed. He was used to the rude and unkind way some Jewish people treated him. Then he saw a Levite walking towards him. He was just as rude. Sam sighed again.

Suddenly Sam heard a man groaning. He found a Jewish man lying under a bush by the road. He was bruised and bleeding and very ill. He had been beaten by robbers and they had stolen his clothes and

his money. Sam wanted to treat everyone with the kindness and love that he would like someone to show him. He gave him water to drink, cleaned his cuts, and wrapped them in bandages. Sam

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helped him onto the back of his donkey, and together they made the long and difficult trip down the road to Jericho.

Sam could see that the man was too ill to travel anymore, so he took him to an inn with a kind and welcoming innkeeper. Sam promised to pay the innkeeper for looking after the injured man until he was well enough to return home.

Jesus told this story to teach us that everyone is our neighbor. We can show God's loving care and generosity to anyone in need, even if they are from a different culture, and even if they are our enemy, because everyone we meet is a beloved child of God, just like us.

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MEMORY VERSE ACTIVITIES

- Fold a sheet of paper in half.
- Place the fold on the left side and lay your left hand on top of the paper so your little finger is touching the fold.
- Keep your fingers close together, draw around your hand and then cut it out to make a paper hand shape.
- Open it like a greeting card. Write 'Love your enemies' on the left hand and 'Pray for those who hurt you' on the right hand.

PRAYER ACTIVITIES

PRAYERS FOR PEOPLE IN OTHER COUNTRIES

- Find a map of the world. Look at the different countries and take it in turns to choose a country and pray for the people in that country. What are their special needs? Pray that Christians will be able to share the love of God with others in that country.
- Draw a large, rough map of the world in the sand, or use chalks to draw it on the sidewalk. Walk slowly and gently over the map, praying for people in different parts of the world. Pray that their hearts will be open to listen to the Holy Spirit and discover God's love.

FAMILY ACTIVITIES

RETELL THE STORY

- Choose a way to retell the story of the Good Samaritan for your culture.
- Change his name and the situation to tell the story of a person helping someone who is very different to them, or who might even be their enemy.
- You can act it out, write the story in your own words, make a model of the story, and tell it using toy people, or draw pictures to illustrate it.
- What does this story mean to you? Who might you be able to help? How could you help others safely, even though you are a child? (run and tell an adult to help).
- Who else might need a friend in the story? The Levite, the innkeeper, the priest, the Samaritan, or even the robbers?

WELCOME!

- If possible, invite a family from another culture to share a meal with you.
- Make a traditional dish from your culture and invite them to bring a treat from their culture.
- Ask them about their cultural traditions, crafts and songs and share some of yours so that you have a fun time learning about each other!

BEAUTIFUL CULTURES!

- Explore a different culture to your own. Find books, videos, or other resources to help you.
- Learn some of the special things that they like to eat, some of their traditions and celebrations, and what people wear.
- Make a simple dish from this culture and enjoy eating it together, or purchase food from this culture to try.
- Learn to say “I love you! And Jesus loves you!” in a different language.
- Make a craft from this culture, such as simple paper origami from Japan.

WEDNESDAY SNAPSHOT!

THE VERSE

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THE INTRODUCTION

One of the greatest evidences of God’s love working on our hearts, and changing us to become more like Him, is our ability to be kind and respectful to people from all cultures, and with all kinds of diversity.

THE DEVOTIONAL

We can show God’s loving care and generosity to anyone in need, even if they are from a different culture, and even if they are our enemy, because everyone we meet is a beloved child of God, just like us.

THE PRAYER

Pray that Christians will be able to share the love of God with others in that country.

THE CONVERSATION

Share how living in your country impacts your family’s identity. Discuss ways to make people from different cultures feel safe and welcome with you.